

Sunday, 30 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Showers 22° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Showers 21° 15°	MANCHESTER Showers 20° 15°	GLASGOW Heavy rain 18° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A Christian festival has been left 'devastated' after a man died and several others were injured in an incident at the Big Church Festival.

Police are investigating the circumstances surrounding the death, which also saw at least six other people hurt. The popular event draws thousands of attendees each year.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 2

Royal Navy warships have spent three days tracking Russian vessels as they passed through UK waters.

HMS Duncan, HMS St Albans, and HMS Severn monitored four Russian ships using their radars. The vessels were tracked through the North Sea and English Channel.

DEFENCE · UK
- 3

A mother whose son was murdered has joined calls to stop killers from being released early from prison.

Emma Webber is among more than 30 families who have signed an open letter to the government. They are campaigning for changes to sentencing laws.

JUSTICE · UK
- 4

A murder investigation is underway in County Tyrone after a man was found dead and a child seriously injured.

Police were called to an incident in Lisnahull Road in Dungannon. Details are still emerging about what happened.

CRIME · UK
- 5

Senior politician James Cleverly has announced he is quitting the shadow cabinet to run for London mayor.

The next mayoral election for the capital isn't due until 2028, giving him a long campaign ahead. His resignation will spark a reshuffle within his party.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 The mysterious Scouse rapper EsDeeKid caused a stir with an 'insane' set at All Points East festival, despite their identity remaining a secret.**

Fans are loving the music and energy, proving that sometimes, not knowing who's behind the mask only adds to the allure. It seems the mystery is no problem for music lovers.

ON AIR – Would you rather know everything about an artist, or do you prefer a bit of mystery?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 2 Rising London musician Kamal has opened up about the 'scary' moment he reached out to superstar Dave for his debut album.**

Kamal is aiming for 'honesty' in his upcoming release, reflecting a growing trend for artists to be truly authentic. It's a big step for any new artist to collaborate with such a major name.

ON AIR – Who would be your dream collaboration if you were a musician?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 3 Campaigners are calling for Jared Leto's band concerts to be cancelled next year following criminal sexual conduct claims.**

The musician denies the allegations, but the controversy is casting a shadow over his upcoming UK arena dates. This is a developing story that could impact his tour.

ON AIR – How much do an artist's personal controversies affect whether you'd go to their shows?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 The Esports World Cup has concluded with a surprise win for a China-based team, AG.AL, in Paris.**

They claimed the overall title and a massive seven million dollar top prize. This huge event highlights the growing global appeal and incredible prize money in esports.

ON AIR – Do you think esports will ever be as big as traditional sports for casual viewers?

GAMING · WHEN
- 5 The Baller League, a six-a-side football tournament, will no longer be shown on Sky Sports, but will continue on digital platforms.**

Fans can still catch all the action on YouTube, Twitch, and TikTok. This move shows how much sports broadcasting is evolving, with more content heading online.

ON AIR – Do you prefer watching sports on traditional TV or streaming platforms?

SPORT · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Heavyweight boxing predictions are pouring in for Saturday's highly anticipated world title fight between Moses Itauma and Filip Hrgovic.**

Figures from across the boxing world are sharing their thoughts on who will emerge victorious. It promises to be a thrilling night for fight fans.

ON AIR – Are you backing the young talent Itauma, or the more experienced Hrgovic?

BOXING · UK

2 **British number one Katie Boulter has complained that the smell of cannabis is distracting her at the US Open.**

It's an unusual complaint from a top athlete, but Boulter says it's putting her off her game. She's not the first player to mention it at the tournament.

ON AIR – What's the strangest thing that's ever distracted you during a game or important task?

TENNIS · UK

3 **Lando Norris has extended his McLaren deal until 2030, saying a slow start to the season made him want to stay and turn things around.**

In an exclusive interview, Norris explained his long-term commitment to the team. It's a massive show of faith from both driver and constructor.

ON AIR – Do you think Norris has made the right decision to commit long-term to McLaren?

F1 · UK

4 **Great Britain's Arthur Fery is through to his first ATP Tour final after his opponent retired due to injury.**

It's a huge moment for Fery as he reaches a significant milestone in his career at the Winston-Salem Open. He'll be hoping to cap it off with a win.

ON AIR – How much do you think injuries impact a player's ability to reach their full potential in tennis?

TENNIS · UK

5 **England's bowlers ripped through Pakistan's lower order, taking five wickets for just 19 runs in a dominant display.**

Ollie Robinson and Jofra Archer combined to great effect, bowling Pakistan out for 110. This gave England a commanding 180-run lead in their second Test match.

ON AIR – Is this England's strongest bowling attack we've seen in a while?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The surprising power of 'mindful walking' is being embraced by city dwellers for boosting well-being.**
Taking time to truly observe your surroundings while walking, even in a busy urban area, helps reduce stress and enhances appreciation for everyday details. It's about noticing the small things you might usually rush past.
- 2 A growing number of people are discovering the simple joy of 'reading a physical map' for planning excursions.**
There's a real satisfaction in unfolding a map, tracing routes with your finger, and visualising your journey. It offers a different kind of engagement than digital navigation, often revealing hidden gems.
- 3 The delightful trend of 'retro board game nights' is making a comeback, bringing families and friends together for analogue fun.**
Dusting off classics like Cluedo, Monopoly, or even newer, more intricate board games provides a wonderful opportunity for face-to-face interaction and shared laughter away from screens.
- 4 Scientists have found that regularly 'looking at clouds' can surprisingly spark creativity and reduce mental fatigue.**
Cloud-gazing encourages a gentle form of daydreaming and pattern recognition, which can be a refreshing break for the mind. It's a simple, free way to give your brain a little holiday.
- 5 There's a lovely movement to 'rekindle the art of handwritten thank you notes' for expressing genuine gratitude.**
In an age of instant messages, a physical thank you note feels incredibly personal and thoughtful. It shows a little extra effort that recipients truly appreciate and remember.
- 6 New research highlights the emotional benefits of 'revisiting childhood playgrounds or parks' for a dose of nostalgia.**
Walking through familiar childhood haunts can trigger happy memories and a sense of connection to your past. It's a pleasant way to reconnect with simpler times and a younger you.
- 7 The simple act of 'watering houseplants' is being recognised as a meditative and calming daily ritual.**
Taking a few moments to tend to your indoor greenery offers a quiet, focused activity that helps clear the mind and provides a sense of accomplishment. Plus, happy plants make for a happier home!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea bags will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING THE BOX A LITTLE SNIFF, JUST IN CASE!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm piece of toast with their favourite topping, especially if it's a new loaf. What is it?

ANSWER: PRESSING THE TOP OF THE LOAF TO CHECK ITS SQUISHINESS!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' just feels completely indispensable, even if it's something really small or seemingly insignificant?

Is there something in your home or daily routine that you just couldn't do without, even if it seems a bit odd to others? Perhaps a specific mug, a comfy blanket, or even a favourite pen?

- We all have those 'little personal rules' we live by, don't we? Things we always do, or never do, often without really thinking about it.

What's a quirky 'personal rule' that you follow in your life? Maybe it's never putting an empty carton back in the fridge, or always starting your weekend with a specific treat? Share your harmless quirks!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The collective noun for a group of badgers is a 'squabble'.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£67 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's largest hot air balloon festival takes place every October in Albuquerque, New Mexico.
- The longest river in the United Kingdom is the River Severn, flowing 220 miles through Wales and England.
- It is illegal to sing in public in some parts of Canada on a Sunday.
- The 'Big Ben' clock tower in London is actually named Elizabeth Tower; Big Ben is the nickname for the great bell inside.
- A group of flamingos is called a 'flamboyance'.
- Mount Everest grows by about 4 millimetres every year due to tectonic plate movement.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- The traditional red pillar box in the UK was first introduced in 1852.

On this day

Day 242 of the year, 123 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Constantinople (Eastern Orthodoxy); Christian feast day: Blessed Alfredo Ildefonso Schuster; Christian feast day: Blessed Eustáquio van Lieshout; Christian feast day: Blessed Stephen Nehmé (Maronite Church / Catholic Church). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — David Paymer, American actor and director
- 1968 — Diran Adebayo, English author and critic
- 1966 — Michael Michele, American actress
- 1950 — Dana Rosemary Scallon, Irish singer and activist
- 1971 — Lars Frederiksen, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1966 — Peter Cunnah, Northern Irish singer-songwriter and producer
- 1951 — Timothy Bottoms, American actor
- 1985 — Richard Duffy, Welsh footballer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1967 — Thurgood Marshall is confirmed as the first African American Justice of the Supreme Court of the United States.
- 1963 — The Moscow–Washington hotline between the leaders of the U.S. and the Soviet Union goes into operation.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1936 — The RMS Queen Mary wins the Blue Riband by setting the fastest transatlantic crossing.
- 2021 — The last remaining American troops leave Afghanistan, ending U.S. involvement in the war.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2008 — A Conviasa Boeing 737 crashes into Illiniza Volcano in Ecuador, killing all three people on board.
- 1945 — The Japanese occupation of Hong Kong comes to an end.
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1974 — The Third World Population Conference ends in Bucharest, Romania. At the end of the ceremony, the UN-Romanian Demographic Centre is inaugurated.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 243 of the year, 122 days left in 2026. Today Baloch-Pakhtun Unity Day (Balochs and Pashtuns, International observance); Christian feast day: Aidan of Lindisfarne; Christian feast day: Amatus of Nusco; Christian feast day: Aristides of Athens. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Simon Neil, Scottish singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1967 — Gene Hoglan, American drummer
- 1960 — Chris Whitley, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2005)
- 1992 — Holly Earl, British actress
- 1940 — Larry Hankin, American actor, director, and producer
- 1971 — Kirstie Allsopp, British TV presenter
- 1980 — Joe Budden, American broadcaster and former rapper
- 1986 — Ryan Kelley, American actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1959 — A parcel bomb sent by Ngô Đình Nhu, younger brother and chief adviser of South Vietnamese President Ngô Đình Diệm, fails to kill King Norodom Sihanouk of Cambodia.
- 2016 — Brazil's President Dilma Rousseff is impeached and removed from office.
- 1986 — The Soviet passenger liner Admiral Nakhimov sinks in the Black Sea after colliding with the bulk carrier Pyotr Vasev, killing 423.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1988 — Delta Air Lines Flight 1141 crashes during takeoff from Dallas/Fort Worth International Airport, killing 14.
- 2005 — The 2005 Al-Aimmah bridge stampede in Baghdad kills 953 people.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar